

with an active community is that everyone will have an opinion on a tech device or technology, and detailed user reviews on anything and everything are always to be found. Dedicated threads for discussions pertaining to a product or device are a great way to research about something, sifting through information that's been filed methodically. Don't worry if you're new to a tech forum, most members are always happy to help out and outmatch each other's prowess in giving you the most comprehensive answer to your query. Just as long as you don't get drawn into flame wars and keep a low profile, you'll be fine.

While on your quest for thoroughly researching about a mobile device online before purchasing it, make sure you also visit reviews aggregator websites like alatest.com, where you can search for a product and find related reviews linking back to a whole host of websites from around the world, complete with a snapshot of the product's verdict, score or rating, and of course link to the original in-depth review. Think of Alatest.com as the search index for product reviews and the site does what it claims pretty well.

Also, whenever a big product is announced by a manufacturer but it's not yet out for purchase in the market -- think of the hype and euphoria surrounding a brand new Apple product or the announcement of a Samsung Galaxy S4, for instance -- a good tip is to create a Google alert for it. If you've never used the service, Google Alerts is a tremendously useful yet severely under-exploited service offered by the search engine giant which lets you track news surrounding and interesting new content around a search term of your choice. Just head over to google.co.in/alerts and enter your search query (for instance, Samsung Galaxy S4 mini), keep the default 'Result type' but tinker around with the 'How often' field, which relates to how often you'd like Google to keep you updated about the topic of your choice. Set an alert and let Google do its magic, and see how it adds a whole new dimension to your product researching skills.

Whatever you do, however, do not get swayed by 'user reviews' posted on shopping sites, as they're often misleading and open to abuse. We know it's easy to get influenced by a few consecutive positive (or negative) 'reviews' posted on a product page on an ecommerce website, providing the final impetus towards making or breaking a purchase. Such reviews don't matter, as far as making an educated, well-researched product purchase is concerned -- or if they do, attach minimal importance to them in your scheme of things.